

# Psalms 133

## *How Good and How Pleasant*

Behold, how good and how pleasant it is for brethren to dwell together in unity

KJV · Standalone study handout

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### 1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Behold, how good and how pleasant it is for brethren to dwell together in unity!
- 2 It is like the precious ointment upon the head, that ran down upon the beard, even Aaron's beard: that went down to the skirts of his garments;
- 3 As the dew of Hermon, and as the dew that descended upon the mountains of Zion: for there the LORD commanded the blessing, even life for evermore.

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### 2 · CONTEXT

One of the briefest Songs of Ascents, Psalm 133 captures in three verses what pilgrims arriving together in Jerusalem would have felt: the rare goodness of covenant family gathered in harmony rather than scattered by rivalry. David reaches for two deliberately lavish images—consecrating oil poured on Aaron's head and dew descending on the mountains around Zion—to describe unity as something both sacred and life-giving, not merely comfortable. Henry reads the psalm as a small but weighty commendation of a virtue too easily undervalued until it is missing.

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### 3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

#### Verse 1

The psalm opens with unguarded delight: how good and how pleasant it is for brothers to dwell together in unity. The declaration itself, placed first and alone, signals how rare and valuable this experience actually is.

#### Verse 2-3

Two images unpack that goodness: precious ointment poured on Aaron's head running down to the very hem of his garments, consecrating everything it touches; and dew descending from Hermon onto the mountains of Zion, watering and giving life. The psalm closes by naming the destination of both images—there the Lord commanded His blessing, even life for evermore.

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### 4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

#### Meaning.

Unity among God's people is pictured here as both consecrating, like anointing oil that sets apart everything it covers, and life-giving, like dew that waters otherwise dry ground. Far from a soft or sentimental value, it is the very setting in which the Lord commands His blessing, extending even to life everlasting.

#### Application for life today.

Take an honest inventory of a relationship—family, church, or community—where rivalry or distance has replaced the 'dwelling together' this psalm celebrates, and consider one concrete step toward restoring it. Let the image of oil running down from head to hem remind you that unity's effects are meant to reach further than the immediate parties involved. Ask God specifically for the dew of Hermon in a dry relational season, trusting that He is the one who supplies it, not merely human effort.

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### 5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Where in your life is 'dwelling together in unity' currently rare rather than the norm, and what is one concrete step toward restoring it?

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**2.** How does the image of consecrating oil running from head to hem (v. 2) illustrate the way unity's blessing spreads beyond the immediate people involved?

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**3.** What would it mean to actually pray for the 'dew of Hermon'—God's own provision—rather than relying solely on your own effort to produce unity?

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Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Group / Church: \_\_\_\_\_

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).